

Bazaar

We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

Handspring Treo 180

Digital phone assistant

The blue-grey Treo 180 from Handspring rolls the functionality of a PDA and a cell phone into a single device.

It features a 160 x 160 greyscale screen with a lid. The glass window on the lid lets you see who's calling. There's no graffiti input



mode, but the QWERTY mini-keyboard is quite handy when typing long SMSes.

The device can't read SMS messages off the SIM card, but offers to move them to its own memory when you install the SIM. The SIM Book module can read phone numbers stored on the SIM. Voice clarity is quite good, and there's an inbuilt speakerphone option. The phone supports GPRS, and you can surf the Web using the installed Blazer Web browser.

As a PDA, the Treo 180 offers standard Palm applica-

tions such as the Calculator, Date Book, Memo Pad, World Clock and To Do. The Phonebook works as the contacts manager, and integrates nicely with the phone for direct dialling.

The device connects to a PC through the bundled USB cable; there's no cradle. Syncing is extremely simple: Just install the provided software, and press a button to begin syncing data.

The inbuilt lithium-ion battery lasts for just about a couple of days with standard phone and PDA usage, though this period can stretch to about three weeks if you switch off the wireless mode and use the Treo as a plain PDA.

The Treo 180 can work nicely for you as an integrated solution. The lack of a colour screen and a camera at this price point could be a deterrent, though, and there are newer models in the market that you can consider.

SPECIFICATIONS

33 MHz Motorola Dragonball VZ processor, 16 MB RAM (non-expandable), PalmOS 3.5, 4.2 x 2.8 x 0.8 inches, weight: 147 gms, dual-band GSM 900/1900 MHz, backlit monochrome display, Infra-red, GPRS, Windows and Mac compatible

Handspring Treo 180	B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Usability	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 14,500
Contact: Pitroshni Corporation
Phone: 022-22000013
Fax: 022-22070143
E-mail: pitronsys@yahoo.com
Web site: www.handspring.com

Nokia 6600

Chubby cheeks, dimpled chin

The 6600 from Nokia is a successor to the 7650 and 3650 models, and is much better designed. It's smaller, lighter, oval shaped and uses a Series 60 platform. It has a dual-tone finish. The five-directional joystick is flanked by two customisable soft-keys. The camera sits in the centre of a circular panel at the rear.

It has a 176 x 208 pixel active matrix TFT display which supports 65,536 colours; MIDI is supported. The internal memory is 6 MB, but a 32 MB MMC card is included for additional memory. The integrated camera captures video clips at 176 x 144 or 128 x 96 pixels. Standard messaging features are supported. You can connect to other devices using Bluetooth or Infra-red. GPRS and High Speed Circuit Switched Data (HSCSD) data transfer speeds reach 40.2 Kbps and 43.2 Kbps respectively. It has voice dialling, voice commands, a voice recorder and a hands-free speaker.

Voice clarity is excellent, you'll have no problems, even in a noisy environment.

The startup time is quite long, and even the backlight takes time to come on. However, when it does, you see a clear and bright screen. Screen visibility reduces in direct sunlight, but is usable. Still pictures captured using the camera come out fine in good lighting conditions. There's no flash.

The video-capture quality is plain acceptable; The audio captured with the video is better. A sore point is the length of captured clips—just about nine seconds. The included BL-5C battery offers a couple of days' life with normal usage.

The 6600 is definitely a phone to consider buying, especially if you can afford the price. However, there are not many compelling reasons for existing Nokia 7650 or 3650 users to switch to it.

SPECIFICATIONS

Tri-band (GSM E900/1800/1900), Symbian OS 7.0, dimensions: 108.6 x 58.2 x 23.7 mm, weight: 125 gms, integrated 640 x 480 camera with 2X digital zoom, video recorder, 32-note polyphony, GPRS, WAP, HSCSD



Price: Rs 23,799
Contact: Nokia India
Phone: 011-26779000
Fax: 011-26779147
E-mail: nokia.ebag@nokia.com
Web site: www.nokia.co.in

Nokia 6600	B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶